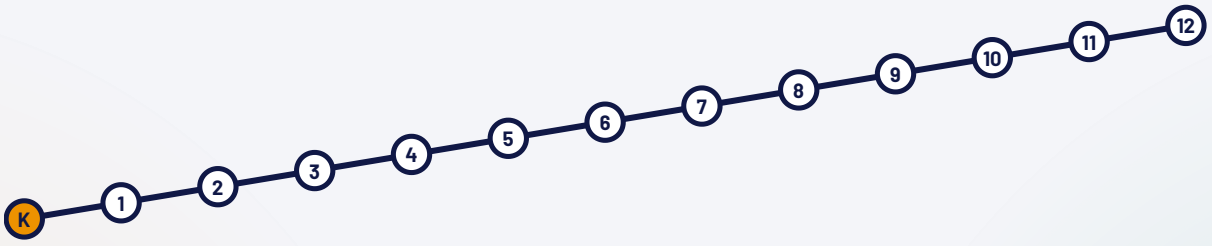
Awsaj Academy

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT · AN ANALYTICAL WALKTHROUGH

Our Curriculum Journey: Social Studies

What our teachers' ratings tell us about how our standards are taught, K-12, and where we could go next.



From the ratings you entered as teachers (2,709 ratings, November 2026): what was reported as taught, not what students know.

Contents

1	**Social Studies, K-12** Social Studies from Kindergarten to Grade 12.	3
2	**About the data (at the back)** Where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use, the limits.	10

Each part: the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each. Items link to the Vertical Alignment site. About the data is at the back. 13 pages, A4.

Taught in depth Introduced / exposed Not taught

SOCIAL STUDIES, KINDERGARTEN TO GRADE 12

Social Studies, K-12

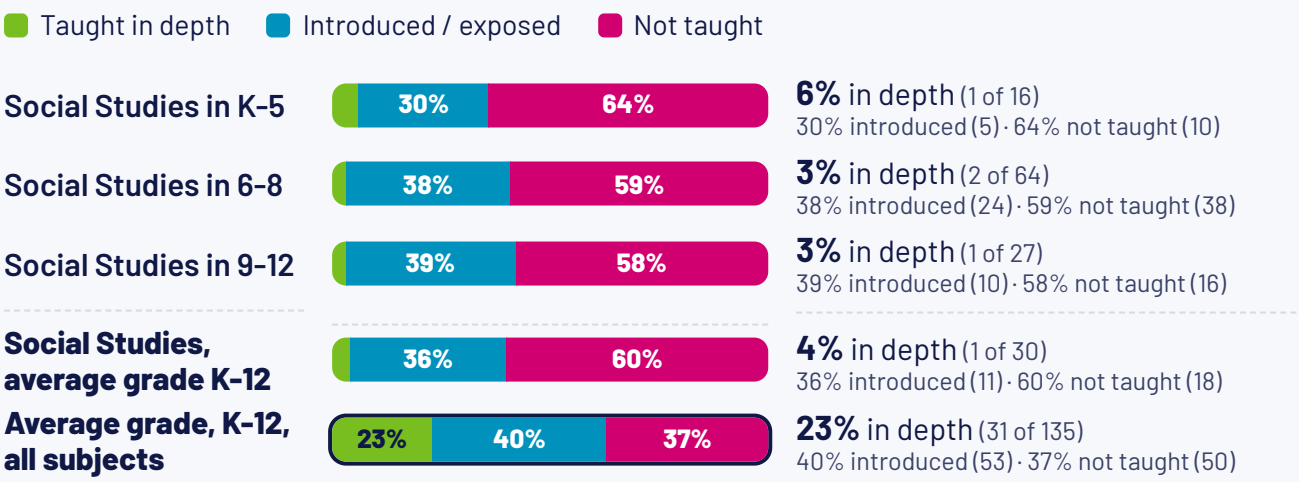
Across K-12, teachers reported that 40% of the 395 Social Studies ratings (225 standards) are at least introduced, and 4% are taught in depth. It is the subject where a few shared choices could make the biggest difference, and it has clear starting points: Kindergarten (40% in depth) and an Economics thread in Grades 6 and 11.

THE PICTURE

At a glance: our curricular capacity

What you are seeing. An average grade in a year, by subject: green in depth, blue introduced, pink not taught, with the number of standards.

What it adds to our story. Social Studies is mostly introduced. This is where a few shared choices could make the biggest difference.



Curricular capacity: what an average grade reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. From 395 grade-level ratings, Essential Elements apart. Not a target.

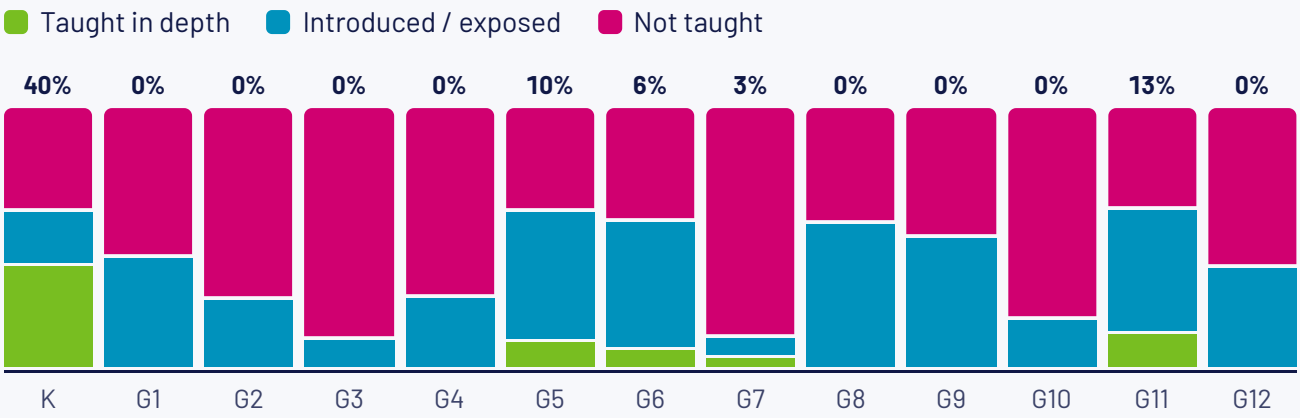
Open the coverage map on the site ↗

THE PICTURE

Grade by grade

What you are seeing. One column per grade. The top number is the share taught in depth.

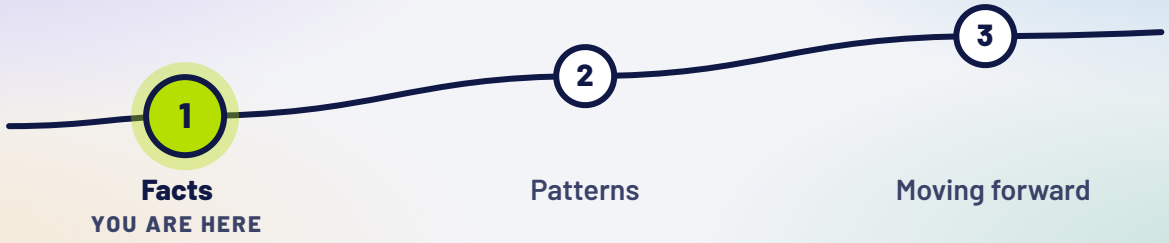
What it adds to our story. Kindergarten starts strongly. After that Social Studies is mostly introduced, perhaps because much of the time goes to literacy.



	Elementary						Middle						
Strand	K	G1	G2	G3	G4	G5	G6	G7	G8	G9	G10	G11	G12
Time, Continuity, and Change	100%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Connections and Conflict	100%	0%	0%	0%	0%	100%							
Culture	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Society and Identity	67%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Government	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Production, Distribution, and Consumption	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Science, Technology, and Society	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%							
Geography		0%	0%	0%	0%	25%							
Behavioral Sciences							17%	0%	0%				0%
Economics							23%	0%	0%			23%	
Geography							0%	17%	0%	0%			
History							0%	0%	0%		0%		0%
Inquiry Practices and Processes							0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Political Science							0%	0%	0%				0%

How to read this: each square is the share of that strand's rated standards taught in depth in that grade. Darker green means more in depth. A blank square means the grade has no standards in that strand.

Open the grade dashboards ↗ Gaps and repetition ↗ Progressions ↗



SECTION 1 OF 3

Facts

What you are seeing. The five main facts. Each links to its data on the site.

What it adds to our story. Many topics are at least introduced across the school, and Economics shows what a thread taught to depth can look like.

1. BRIGHT SPOTS **Economics and Kindergarten are the bright spots.** Economics holds 6 of the 15 in-depth ratings (3 in Grade 6, 3 in Grade 11). Four of Kindergarten's 10 standards are in depth, in identity, time and connections. Coverage map ↗

2. GAPS **Standards not taught in any grade they belong to.** 59 confirmed (K-5 38, 6-8 18, 9-12 3). A further 46 are rated not taught in the grade or course where they fit. Gaps and repetition ↗

3. GAPS **Strands with no standard rated in depth.** K-5: Government, Culture, Production and Consumption, and Science, Technology and Society. Grades 6 to 12: Inquiry Practices (70 ratings), History (60) and Political Science (44). Coverage map ↗

4. GAPS **Progressions break down mostly in K-5.** 21 of 64 break down: 15 break at a K-5 grade (mostly Grade 2 or Grade 3) and 6 in Grades 6 to 12. None is yet taught at every step. Progressions ↗

5. GAPS **Priority and power standards.** 5% in depth and 55% not taught, across 183 ratings. In Grade 7, 94% of priority standards are not taught. Priority and power (Audit) ↗



SECTION 2 OF 3

Patterns

What you are seeing. What the facts show side by side. Possibilities to discuss, not conclusions.

What it adds to our story. Social Studies may be where much of our literacy happens, so planning the two together could help both.

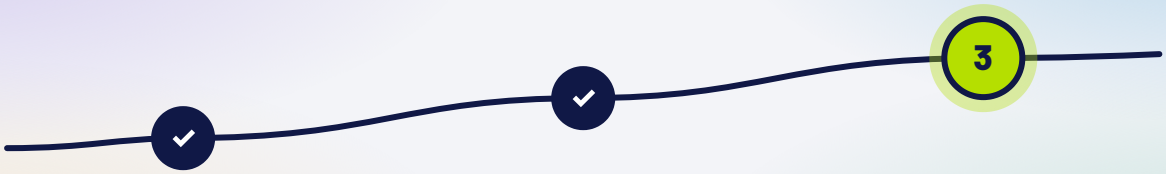
1. TRENDS ACROSS THE GRADES **Social Studies is consistent across the whole school.** Unlike the other subjects, it does not rise or dip by band. This looks like a whole-school pattern, not the story of any one team. Coverage map ↗

2. HANDOFFS **Economics also holds most hand-over gaps.** 5 of the 7 hand-over gaps sit in Economics: 3 Grade 6 Economics standards build on K-5 standards rated not taught, and 2 Grade 11 standards build on Grade 6. Progressions ↗

3. CHOICES AND CAPACITY **The subject is introduced, rarely deepened.** Where Social Studies is taught, it is rated "introduced" about 9 times for every 1 time "in depth" (142 against 15). Review and assessment across all classes may be what is missing for "in depth". Coverage map ↗

4. CHOICES AND CAPACITY **Few shared standards reach depth in any grade.** Middle school standards belong to all three grades, and high school standards span several courses: 80 of 86 shared standards reach depth nowhere. When a standard belongs to everyone, each grade may leave it to another. Coverage map ↗

5. CHOICES AND CAPACITY **High school looks organised by course.** Grade 9 Geography (92% introduced), Grade 11 Economics (23% in depth), Grade 12 History (58% introduced). Standards outside each year's course show as not taught. Coverage map ↗



SECTION 3 OF 3

Moving forward

What you are seeing. Five questions for teams, each with its data and a first step we could take.

What it adds to our story. A few Social Studies standards per grade to take deeper, often through literacy we already teach.

1

IMPROVING THE CURRICULUM **Which 5 to 8 Social Studies standards per grade matter most for our students in Qatar, and would we commit to taking those to depth?**

(Data: 15 of 395 ratings in depth; each middle school grade rates 64 standards) see Fact 4

First step: We could choose 5 to 8 Social Studies standards in each grade to take to depth, and plan them into units we already teach.

Coverage map ↗

2

IMPROVING THE CURRICULUM **Could Social Studies inquiry and ELA research be planned as one sequence from Grade 6 to Grade 12?**

(Data: 0 of 70 Inquiry ratings in depth; Grades 9 and 10 rate all 10 Inquiry standards not taught; secondary ELA is over 50% in depth) see Fact 1

First step: We could start with one Grade 6 unit that counts for both subjects.

Coverage map ↗

3

WORKING ACROSS GRADE LEVELS **For standards shared across Grades 6 to 8, which grade introduces, which deepens and which assesses?**

(Data: 80 of the 86 standards rated by 2 or more grades are in depth in none) see Pattern 4

First step: We might ask Grades 6 to 8 to agree which grade introduces, deepens and assesses each shared standard.

Coverage map ↗

4

KNOWING THE BANDS ABOVE AND BELOW **Where does the AERO K-5 sequence hand over to the Wisconsin Grade 6 standards, and who should map it?**

(Data: 5 hand-over gaps run from K-5 into Grades 6 and 7, all on suggested links not yet checked by teachers) see Fact 5

First step: We could ask K-5 and Grade 6 teachers to check the 5 suggested links together.

Progressions ↗

5

HOW WE RATE AND PLAN **Do our priority and power lists match what our units and courses teach, and if not, which should change?**

(Data: 55% of 183 priority and power ratings not taught, against 18% to 20% in the other subjects) see Fact 5

First step: We could start with Grade 7 (17 of 18 not taught) and Grades 2 and 3, keeping the standards our units already teach.

Priority and power (Audit) ↗

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM AND HOW TO READ THEM

About the data

What our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, K-12. Eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands and the four subjects. Each part opens with the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each.

ABOUT THE DATA

How to read this paper

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

What our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, K-12. Eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands and the four subjects. Each part opens with the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each.

Where the numbers come from. The ratings sheet of 9 November 2026 (2,166 standards, 2,709 ratings), checked against the Vertical Alignment reports.

The three ratings.

Rating	What it means
Taught in depth	ALL classes in the grade consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard
Introduced / exposed	Anything in between (for example, 3 of 5 classes)
Not taught	No class in the grade teaches it

Keep in mind.

- The ratings report teaching across a whole grade, not what students know, and they judge no one.
- "In depth" is all or nothing. Teams may have read it more or less strictly.
- Much literacy is also taught in Science and Social Studies, and may not show in the ELA ratings.
- Shares are of grade-level ratings. Essential Elements are counted apart.

Curricular capacity. What an average grade reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. Not a target: we cannot teach everything equally, so we choose the mix on purpose.

Categories. Each item carries a small label (for example Bright spots, Gaps, Handoffs), the same set in every part, so a team can follow one kind of observation across parts.

ABOUT THE DATA

Method, sources and limits

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

Every figure in this paper was computed from the ratings sheet and cross-checked against the site. Where the site's band and K-12 views differ (progressions), the paper says which it uses. Percentages are rounded half up, as on the site.

What was read

Source	How it was used	How fully it was read
Ratings sheet, "All Standards and Ratings K-12" (9 Nov 2026)	Every figure	All 2,166 rows
Organized ratings workbook	Cross-check of totals	All tabs
20 Findings decks (band and subject)	Cross-check, questions and next-step themes	All slides and speaker notes
K-12 Reports PDF (118 pages)	Cross-check	First 80 pages scanned by search; a few read directly
7 other Reports PDFs	Cross-check of headline figures	Scanned by search, not read page by page

How terms are used

- **Rated standards.** One rating is one standard in one grade. A standard shared by several grades is counted once for each grade that rated it.
- **At least introduced.** Rated in depth or introduced.
- **Not taught where it belongs (confirmed).** The grade the standard belongs to rated it not taught (for a standard shared across grades, every grade that shares it did). In Math and ELA each standard belongs to one grade, so this means that grade's team rated it not taught; it does not mean other grades should have taught it.

- **Not taught where it fits.** Each standard was placed in the grade or course where it fits best, and that grade or course rated it not taught. Other grades were not asked to rate it.
- **Introduced, not taken to depth.** Rated introduced by the grade (or grades) that rate it, and in depth by none. Most standards belong to one grade, so this counts what each grade introduces without taking to depth; it does not mean another grade should teach it again.
- **Progression finding.** An automatic check on a chain of linked standards: a step not taught, or a standard in depth while the one it builds on is not taught.
- **Taught at every step.** Every standard in the chain, across two or more grades, is at least introduced.
- **Progression.** A chain of linked standards across grades. Official links are the Coherence Map (Math), anchor standards (ELA) and the standards' own structure (Science, Social Studies). Other links are suggestions.
- **Curricular capacity.** The average number of standards one grade rated in depth, introduced and not taught in a year (all ratings divided by the number of grades), rounded.
- **Hand-over gap.** A standard taught in depth while a standard it builds on, placed in an earlier school, is rated not taught.
- **Priority and power standards.** Standards the school's own documents name: power standards in K-5, priority standards in 6-12.

Limits to keep in view

- Ratings are teachers' judgements of teaching across a grade. They are not observations and not student results.
- Grades may have read "in depth" differently. Uniform ratings across a whole grade are a reason to check how the scale was read; the paper points these out so teams can discuss them.
- Each team rated its own subject. Literacy taught in Science and Social Studies, and Math taught in Science, may not show in the ELA and Math ratings.
- Middle school Science and high school Math, Science and Social Studies standards were placed in the grade or course where each fits best. 24 K-5 Social Studies standards are also rated not taught in the grade where they fit.
- Band counts of progressions look only at steps inside the band, so they do not add up to the K-12 figure.

- Literacy audit figures come from the 2026 PK-5 literacy audit of weekly plans.
- Some strands have few standards in a grade, so a single rating can move a percentage a long way. Counts are given where this matters.
- Suggested links between standards (most ELA, Science and Social Studies hand-overs) have not been checked by teachers.

Status. This is a draft for the Vertical Alignment Committee. Each finding should be checked with the teams concerned before it is treated as settled. The planned review of weekly and unit plans (Part 2) will test many of these patterns against what is actually planned.